

100 Days of Linux - Day 017

Title: Editing Files with nano

Today's Goal

Learn how to create, edit, save, and exit files using the **nano** text editor.

Why This Matters

Linux professionals often edit configuration files, shell scripts, SQL files, and Python programs directly from the terminal. Nano is one of the easiest editors for beginners.

Command of the Day: nano

Syntax: nano filename

Explanation: Opens or creates a text file in the Nano editor.

Important Keyboard Shortcuts

Ctrl + O → Save file

Enter → Confirm filename

Ctrl + X → Exit Nano

Ctrl + K → Cut current line

Ctrl + U → Paste cut line

Ctrl + W → Search text

Example: nano notes.txt

Beginner Lesson

Unlike touch, which creates an empty file, Nano lets you create and edit text inside a file. After opening Nano, simply type your text. Use Ctrl + O to save, press Enter to confirm, and Ctrl + X to exit.

Practice Questions

1. Create a file named notes.txt using nano and write five lines about yourself. Save the file and exit Nano.
2. Open notes.txt again and add two more lines. Save the changes and exit.
3. Search for a word inside notes.txt using Nano's search shortcut.
4. Create a file named commands.txt and write the Linux commands you learned from Day 1 to Day 16.
5. Display the contents of commands.txt using the cat command after exiting Nano.

Hints

Remember the sequence: nano → type text → Ctrl + O → Enter → Ctrl + X.

Mini Challenge

Create a file named diary.txt. Write 10 lines describing your Linux

learning journey so far. Save it, close Nano, then display the file using cat.

Common Mistakes

Closing Nano without saving. Always press Ctrl + O before Ctrl + X if you want to keep your changes.

Did You Know?

Many Linux servers only provide terminal access, so editing files from the command line is an essential skill.

Pro Tip

Look at the bottom of the Nano window—the most useful keyboard shortcuts are always displayed there.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: nano notes.txt → Ctrl+O → Enter → Ctrl+X

Q2: nano notes.txt (edit and save)

Q3: Ctrl+W ■■■■ Nano

Q4: nano commands.txt

Q5: cat commands.txt

Homework

Create three different text files using Nano. Practice editing, saving, searching, and reopening them until you can do it confidently.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll review everything from Days 11–17 with a practical file management and editing quiz.